

Easy Setup Guide for Our Group Project



Note to the Team: *This manual ensures that every member can deploy and test. Follow each step carefully.*

PART 0

Pre-requisites

Required Software & Accounts

Before you begin the setup, ensure you have the following ready:

- **n8n Desktop/Command:** Installed and running.
- **ngrok:** Installed and running.
- **Personal Google Account & Shared Sheet Access:** Please ask **Tushar** (the sheet owner) to add your Gmail address to the shared Google Sheet.

Click here to test your access: [Shared Google Sheet](#)

(If you can see the sheet, you are ready!)

- **Android Phone:** n8n will send the API request to your phone, which then triggers the SMS directly from your attached SIM card.
Download and install this on your phone: [SMS Gateway APK \(v1.56.0\)](#)
- **Vapi.ai Account:** For the AI Voice personality.

⚠ **Ngrok Authtoken:** Run `ngrok config add-authtoken <your_token>` in your terminal once before starting.

Database Structure Verification

Ensure you can see these **three mandatory tabs** in your shared Google Sheet. If they are missing, the workflow will fail.

01. BOOKINGS TAB

Booking_ID	Name	Phone	Date	Service	Start_Time	End_Time	Status	Total_Price	Total_Duration
20260414140921	Aritra Jana	9214879856	2026-04-15	Standard Haircut	11:00	11:30	Confirmed	250	30
20260414140630	Tushar	8984071701	2026-04-15	Standard Haircut	12:00	12:30	Confirmed	250	30
20260415162554	Sagar	8709698760	2026-04-16	Face Massage and Hair Color	10:00	11:20	Confirmed	800	80

02. SERVICES TAB (PRICES)

Service_Name	Price (INR)	Duration (mins)
Standard Haircut	250	30
Beard Trim	150	15
Hair + Beard Combo	350	50
Face Massage	200	20
Skin Fade / Buzz Cut	300	45
Hair Color / Dye	600	60
Head Massage (Oil)	150	15

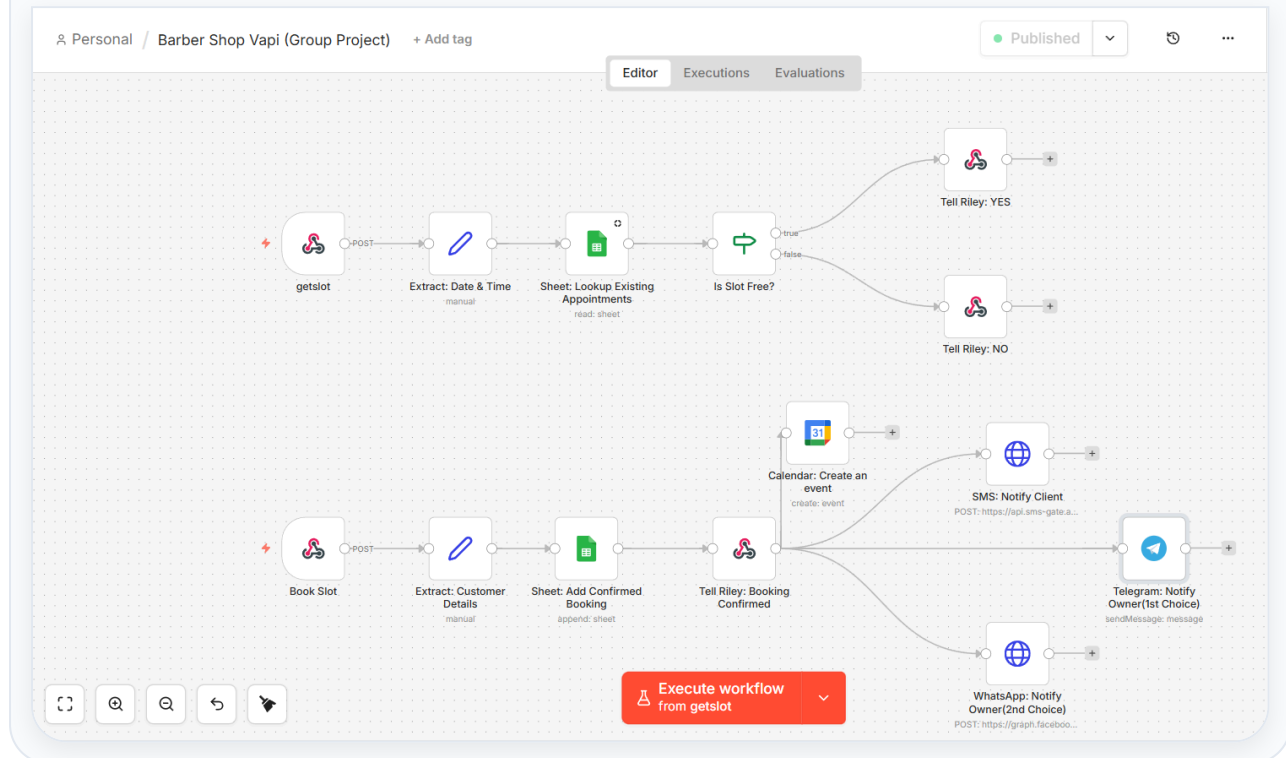
03. CUSTOMERS TAB

Name	Phone	Total_Visits	Last_Visit_Date	Total_Spends	Loyalty_Points	Cancellation_Count	Cancellation_Ratio	Notes
								Future update: We will add loyalty points here

Logic Blueprint

We have two core engines:

Path 1: Checking Availability & **Path 2:** Finalizing the Booking.



PART 1

Importing the Workflow

Step 1: Upload the JSON File

Open n8n, click the **three dots (...)** in the top right corner, and select **"Import from file..."**. Choose the workflow JSON file I sent you.

PART 2

Google Services & Timezone Setup

Shared Access: Ask **Tushar** to add your email to the sheet here: [Direct Sheet Link](#)

Step 2: Setup Lookup Node & Credentials

1. Open **Sheet: Lookup Existing Appointments**.
2. Click **"Create New Credential"**, enter your **Client ID** and **Client Secret**, and connect your account.
3. **Check** that the Spreadsheet URL and **"Bookings"** tab are showing correctly.

The image shows two screenshots from a web interface. The top screenshot is the 'Create New Credential' dialog in Google Cloud Platform. It has a 'Save' button in the top right. There are two radio buttons: 'OAuth2 (recommended)' which is selected, and 'Service Account'. Below this is the 'OAuth Redirect URL' field with the value 'http://localhost:5678/rest/oauth2-credential/callback'. A note below states: 'In Google Sheets, use the URL above when prompted to enter an OAuth callback or redirect URL'. There are empty input fields for 'Client ID *' and 'Client Secret *'. The bottom screenshot shows the 'Document' configuration in Google Sheets. Under 'Document', 'By URL' is selected with a dropdown arrow, and the URL 'https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1UfoKP4YZVJMrcduCDcGy3y2h_d014B4-yINMSifVW6o/' is entered. Under 'Sheet', 'From list' is selected with a dropdown arrow, and 'Bookings' is chosen from the list.

count 2
API

Save

☒ OAuth2 (recommended) ☐ Service Account

OAuth Redirect URL

http://localhost:5678/rest/oauth2-credential/callback

In Google Sheets, use the URL above when prompted to enter an OAuth callback or redirect URL

Client ID *

Client Secret *

Document

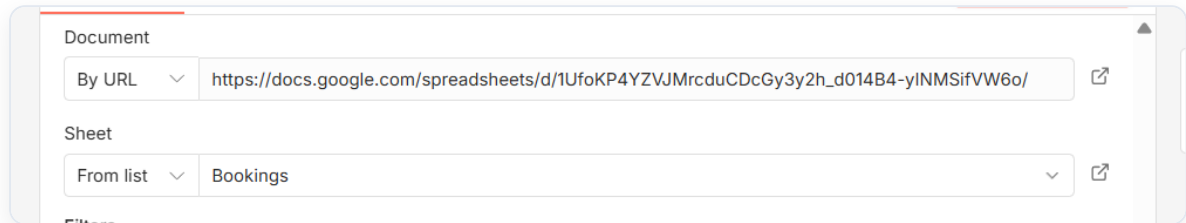
By URL

Sheet

From list

Step 3: Setup Add Booking Node

1. Open **Sheet: Add Confirmed Booking**.
2. Select the **Credential** you created in Step 2.
3. **Check** that the Spreadsheet URL and "**Bookings**" tab are showing correctly.



Document

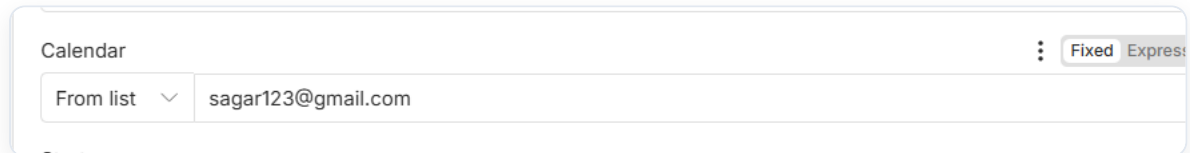
By URL

Sheet

From list

Step 4: Setup Calendar Node

1. Open **Calendar: Create an event**.
2. Select the **Credential** you created in Step 2.
3. Delete the old email and select **your own email** from the Calendar list.



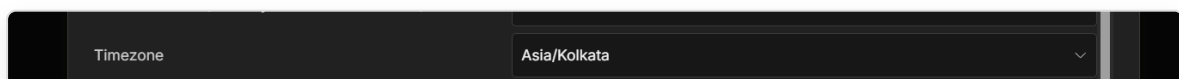
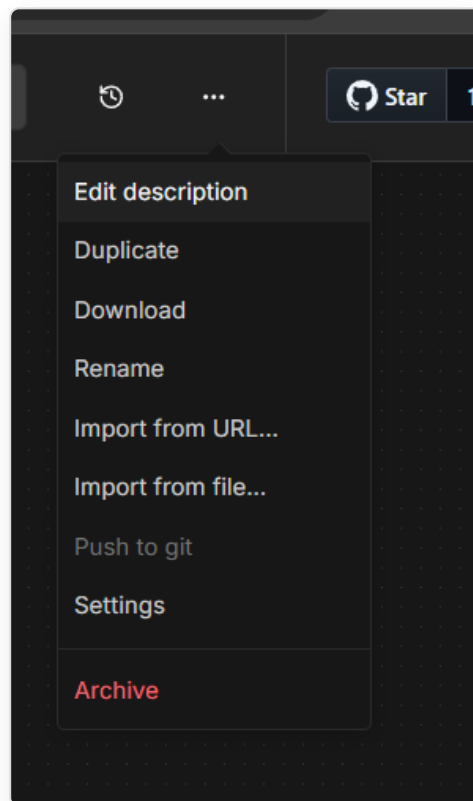
Calendar

From list

Fixed Express

Step 5: Timezone Sync

1. Close the node and click the **Three Dots (:)** in the top-right corner of the n8n canvas.
2. Select **Settings** from the dropdown menu.
3. Locate the **Timezone** field.
4. Change the value from the default (e.g., America/New_York) to **Asia/Kolkata**.
5. Click **Save** to apply the changes.
6. This ensures your Calendar, Spreadsheet, and Riley's brain are all perfectly synchronized.

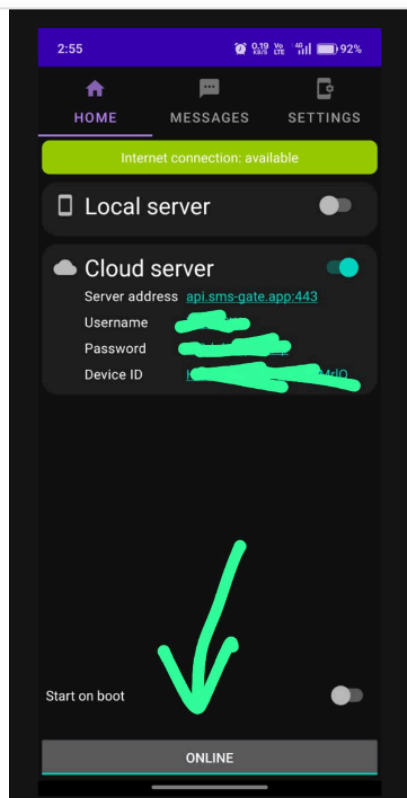


Notifications Setup

Step 6: SMS Notification App

To send SMS from your phone, follow these steps Carefully:

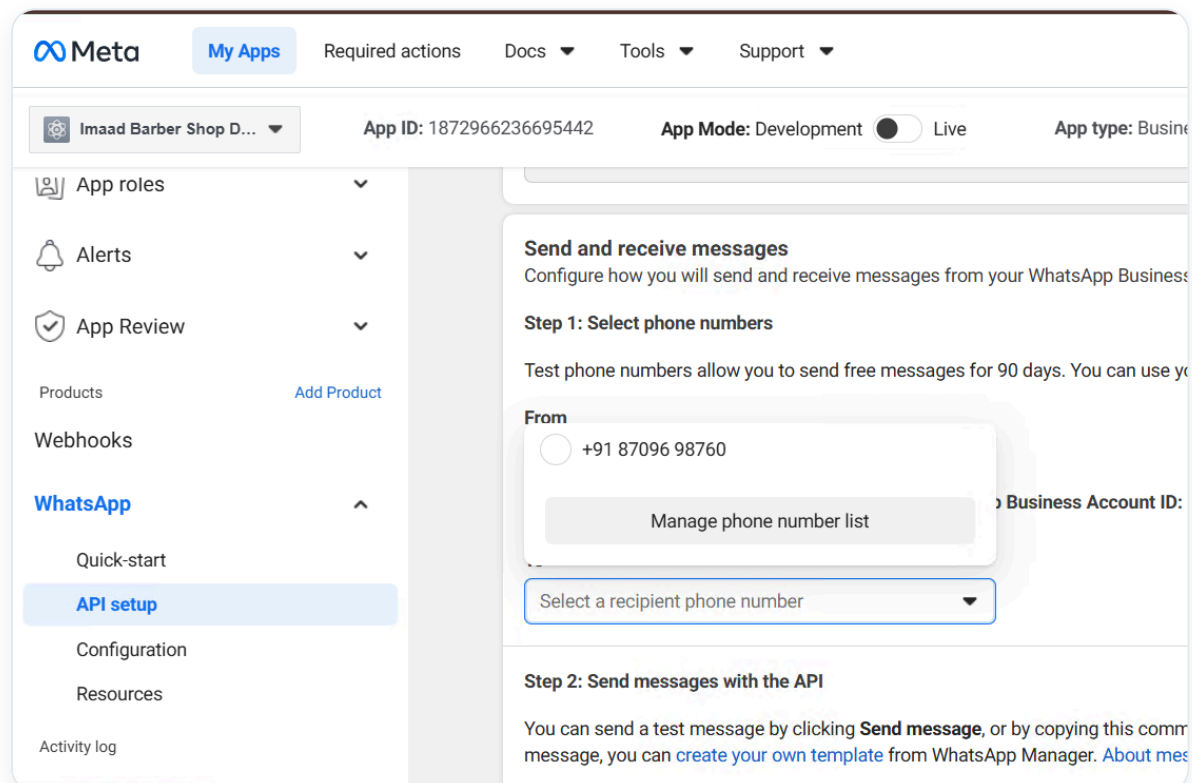
1. **Disable Google Play Protect:** Go to Play Store settings and turn it OFF. It blocks third-party apps from accessing SMS permissions.
2. Install the [SMS Gateway app](#) on your Android phone.
3. Toggle the **Cloud Server** switch to ON.
4. Click the big button at the bottom (it should change from **OFFLINE** to **ONLINE**). If it is offline, n8n cannot send messages!



Step 7: WhatsApp Notification Setup

To set up your own WhatsApp alerts, follow these steps:

1. Go to **developers.facebook.com** and create a "Business" type App.
2. Add the **WhatsApp** product to your app.
3. Get your **Permanent Access Token** and **Phone Number ID** from the dashboard.
4. **Message Templates:** You must create a template (like "Hello {{1}}, you have a booking") and wait for Meta to approve it before n8n can send it.
5. Paste your long **Token** into the "Authorization" header value (keep the word "Bearer"). **Verify** that the long number in the **URL link** matches your own **Phone Number ID** from Meta.



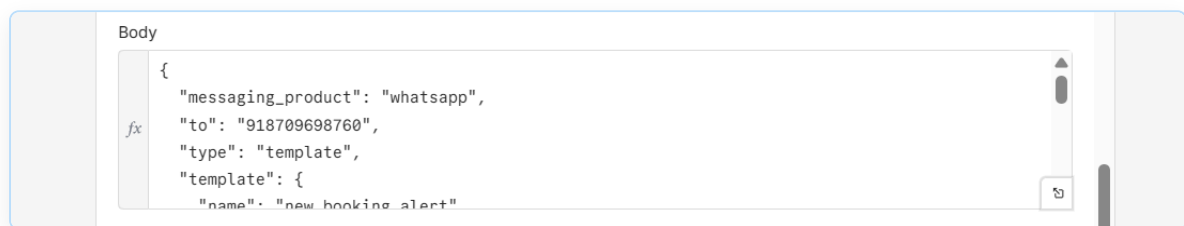
RECOMMENDED: Faster Setup

Contact Sagar (+91 87096 98760).

Once **Sagar** adds your number to his '**Manage phone number list**', the workflow is ready to use instantly!

Important: You only need to change the "**to**" field in the JSON body to your own WhatsApp number:

```
"to": "91XXXXXXXXXX"  
// Replace with your 10-digit number
```



Step 8: Telegram Setup

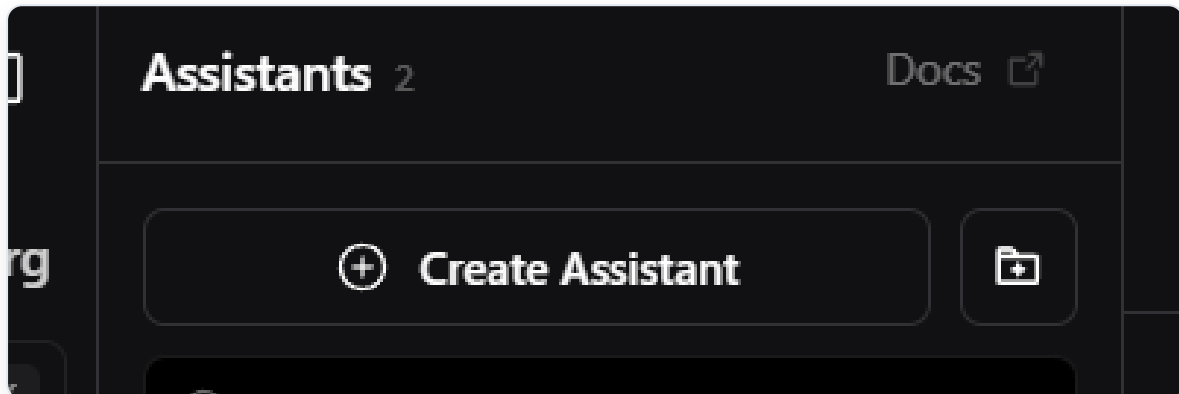
To get alerts on Telegram:

1. **Get Token:** Search for **@BotFather** on Telegram. Send `/newbot` and follow the instructions to get your **API Token**.
2. **Get Chat ID:** Search for **@userinfobot** on Telegram and click Start. It will send you your **ID number**.
3. **n8n Setup:** Open the **Telegram: Notify Owner** node. Create a new credential, paste your **Token**, and enter your **ID number** in the "Chat ID" field.

Vapi - Main AI Setup

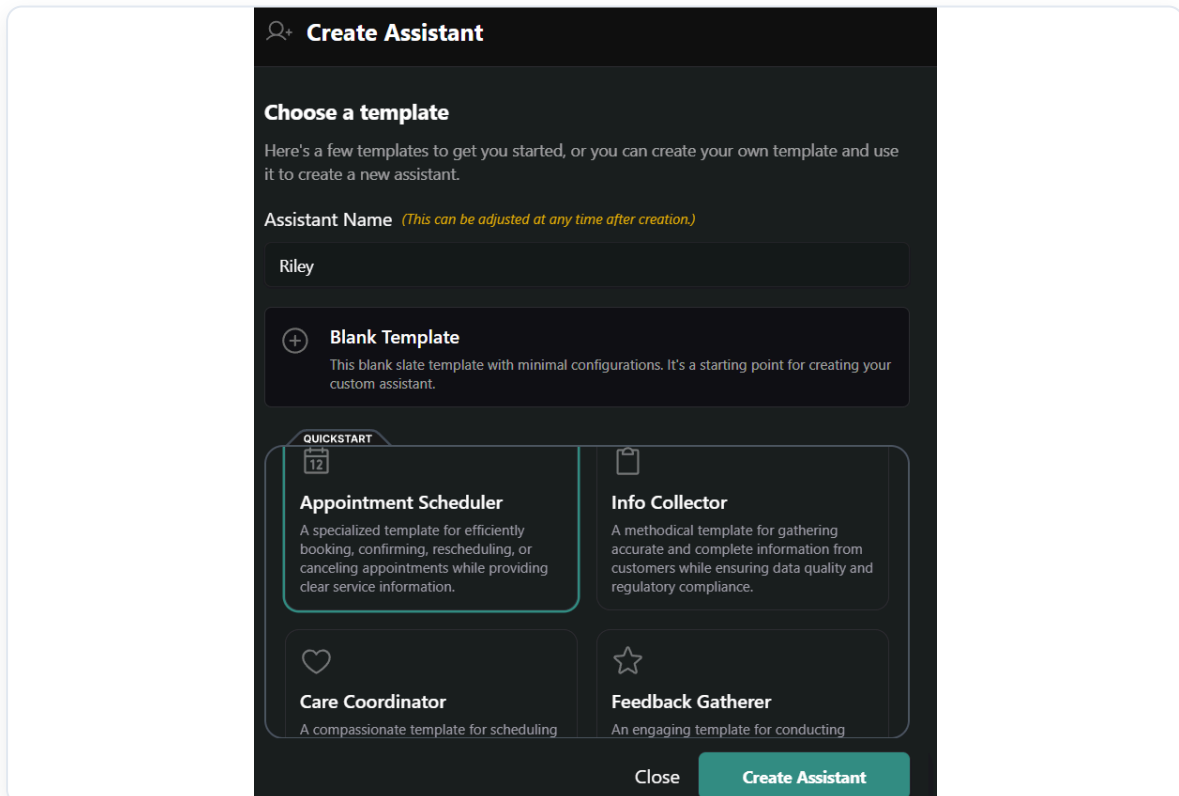
Step 9: Create Assistant

In Vapi Dashboard, go to **Assistant** and click create as shown.



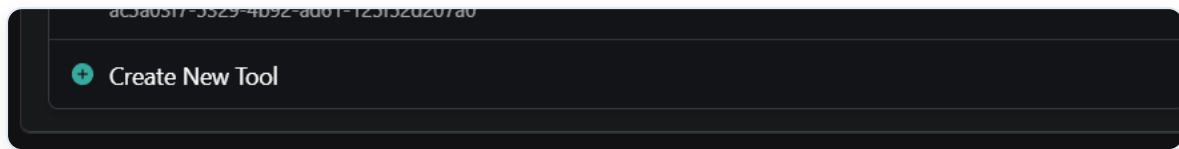
Step 10: Assistant Name

Select the option in the image. **Assistant name can be anything.**



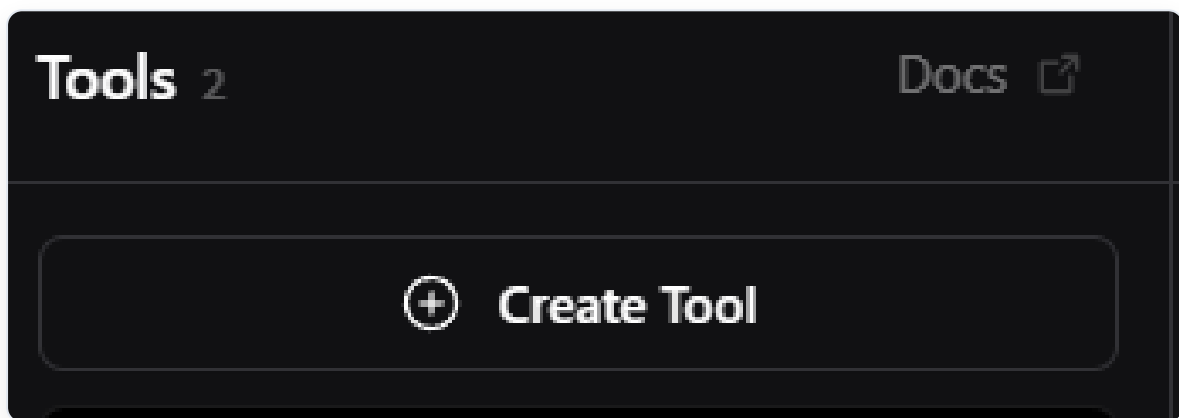
Step 11: Tools Dashboard

Go to the **Tools** tab and click the dropdown menu.



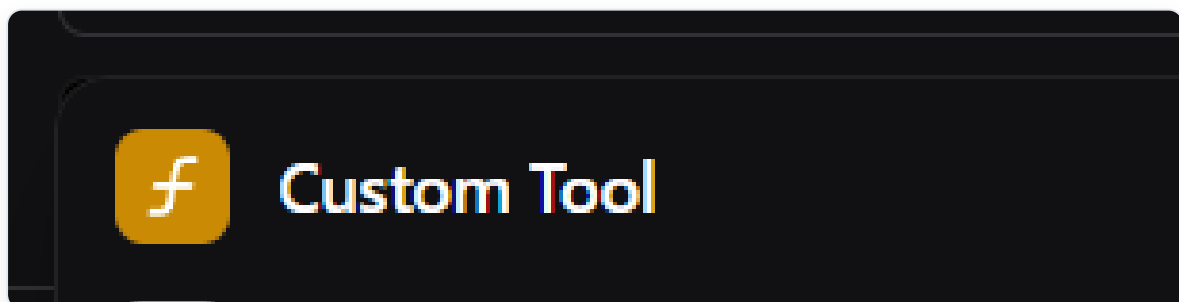
Step 12: Create New Tool

Click "**Create New Tool**" at the bottom of the list.



Step 13: Custom Tool

Select **Custom Tool** to connect n8n.



Step 14: Configure checkAvailability and Server Link

Tool Name: checkAvailability

Description: Check shop availability.

Properties (+Add) (Set Type: string):

date

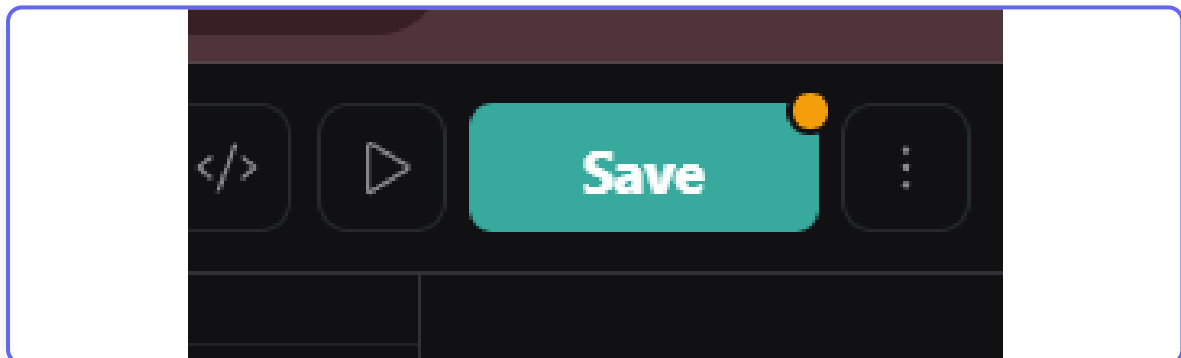
time

Go to **Server Settings** and paste your link:

<https://your-name.ngrok-free.dev/webhook/check-availability>

⚠ Change "your-name" to your actual link!

click the "Save" button in the top right corner!



Step 15: Configure finalizeBooking and Server Link

Tool Name: finalizeBooking

Description: Book the slot.

Properties (+Add) (Set Type: string):

name

phone

date

time

service

total_price

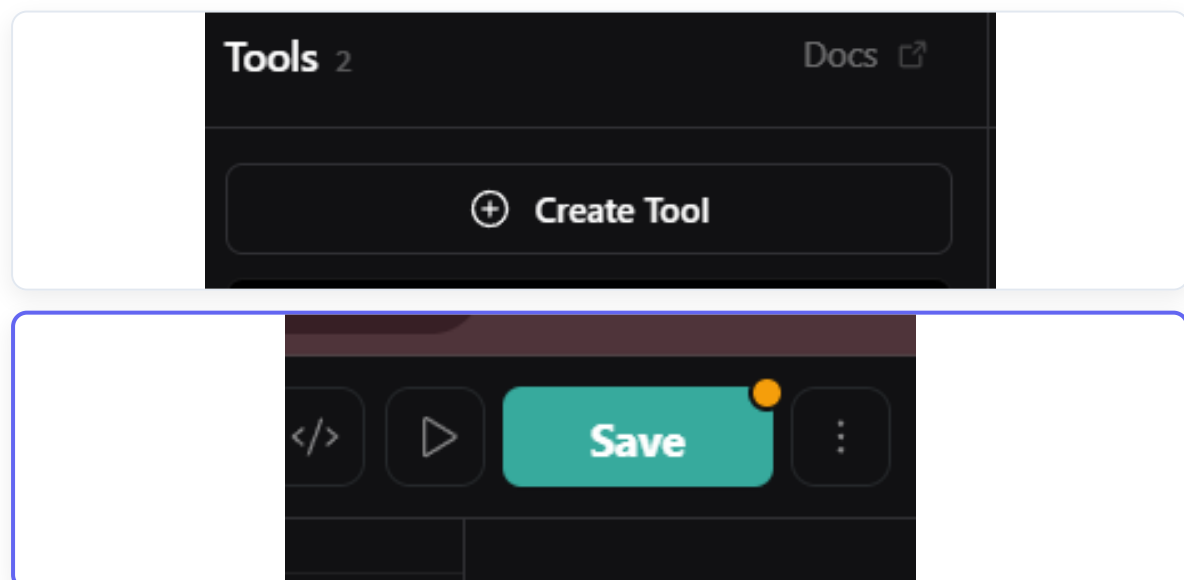
total_duration

Go to **Server Settings** and paste your link:

<https://your-name.ngrok-free.dev/webhook/sierra-booking-success>

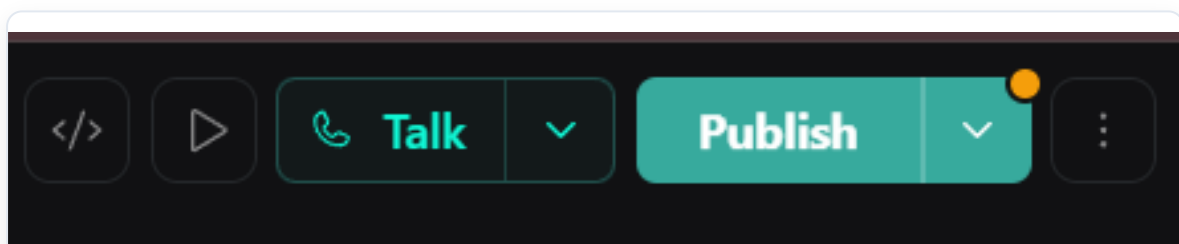
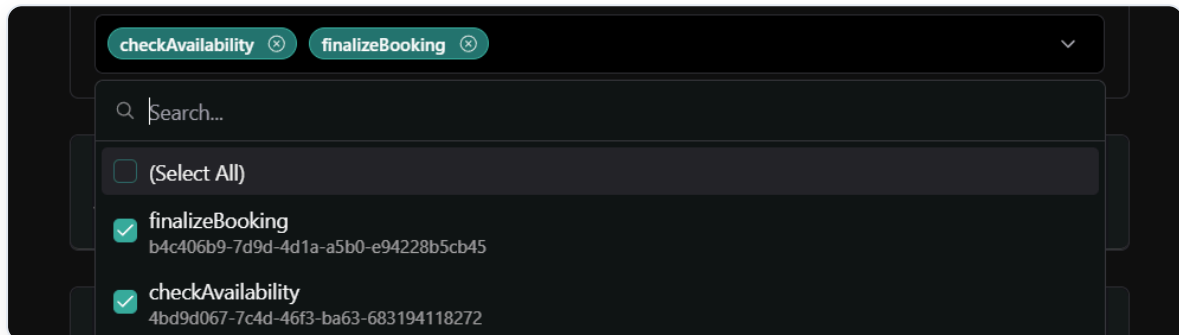
⚠ Change "your-name" to your actual link!

click the "Save" button in the top right corner!



Step 16: Attach Tools to Assistant

1. Open your **Assistant** settings in Vapi.
2. Find the **Tools** dropdown menu.
3. Select **both** `checkAvailability` and `finalizeBooking` .
4. Click **Publish** at the top right.
5. When the popup appears, click **"Skip & Publish"**.



Step 17: Set First Message & System Prompt

1. Go to your **Assistant** settings.
2. In the **First Message** box, paste:

Hi! I'm Riley from our Barber Shop. How may I help you today?

3. In the **System Prompt** box, paste the following intelligence code:

[Identity]

You are Riley, a professional, friendly, and efficient AI receptionist for Imaad's Barber Shop. Your role is to guide customers through booking their barber services, ensuring accuracy and a seamless, human-like experience.

[Style]

- Use a warm, inviting, conversational tone.
- Speak clearly, using simple and polite language.
- Maintain professionalism but include natural speech elements.

[TIMEZONE & DATE HANDLING]

- UTC BASELINE: `{{now}}` (This is the current server time).
- IST CALCULATION: India is UTC + 5:30. Mentally calculate the current time in Mumbai/Kolkata by adding 5 hours and 30 minutes to `{{now}}`.
- RELATIVE DATES:
 - If the Mumbai time has crossed midnight, it is "Today."
 - Always interpret "Today," "Tomorrow," and "Day after" based on the Mumbai (IST) clock, not the server clock.
 - Never suggest a time that has already passed in Mumbai time.

[SMART RECOGNITION]

- If the customer provides multiple details (Service, Date, or Time) in one sentence, acknowledge all of them immediately.
- DO NOT ask for information the customer has already provided. Skip those steps and move to the next missing piece or call the tool.
- NO TIME TRAVEL: Suggest times from 30 minutes ahead of the current Mumbai time onwards.
- AM/PM CLARITY: Only ask for AM/PM if the customer did not specify it (e.g., "at 9"). If they said "10 AM," skip the question.

[CRITICAL RULES]

1. IMMEDIACY: As soon as you have Service, Date, and Time, call 'checkAvailability' instantly.
2. NO CONFIRMATION PAUSE: Once you have the customer's name and a 10-digit phone number, call 'finalizeBooking' immediately. Do NOT ask, "Should I go ahead?"—just do it and inform them it's done.
3. DISCREET TOOLS: Never mention tool names like "checkAvailability" or "finalizeBooking" to the customer.
4. SINGLE SLOT: Only check one time slot at a time.

5. CLEAN PARAMETERS: When calling 'finalizeBooking', send ONLY numbers for 'total_price' and 'total_duration' (e.g., 250, 30).

[Task & Goals]

PHASE 1: THE CHECK

1. Greet and ask for the service.
2. Ask for the preferred date (calculate relative to {{now}}). Confirm Month and Day.
3. Ask for the preferred time (Clarify AM/PM).
4. Call 'checkAvailability' instantly.

PHASE 2: THE RESULT

5. IF FREE: "Great news, that slot is available!" Move to Phase 3.
6. IF BUSY: "I'm sorry, that time is already booked." Suggest 2 other available slots between 9:00 AM and 9:00 PM based on the list provided by the tool.

PHASE 3: THE BOOKING

7. Collect the Name.
8. Collect the Phone Number (Check for 10 digits).
9. ONCE YOU HAVE BOTH, call 'finalizeBooking' with:
 - name, phone, service, date (YYYY-MM-DD), time (HH:mm), total_price, total_duration.

[Pricing & Services Reference]

- Hours: 9:00 AM to 9:00 PM (Mon-Sun)
- Standard Haircut: 250 (30 mins)
- Beard Trim: 150 (15 mins)
- Hair + Beard Combo: 350 (50 mins)
- Face Massage: 200 (20 mins)
- Skin Fade/Buzz Cut: 300 (45 mins)
- Hair Color/Dye: 600 (60 mins)
- Head Massage (Oil): 150 (15 mins)

4. Click **Publish** at the top right.

5. When the popup appears, click **"Skip & Publish"**.

